

Keri Zeller

Instructional Designer & Learning Experience Strategist | EdTech | AI in Education

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Professional Summary

Instructional designer and EdTech founder with 18+ years designing learning across K–12, higher education, and adult professional development in six countries. I build online curricula, faculty and trainer development programs, and digital learning platforms grounded in ADDIE and backward design (UbD). I co-founded a gender-inclusive EdTech startup in Uzbekistan, scaled online curricula for global learners, and founded a faculty development department that supported 175+ faculty through the move to online teaching. My Ed.D. research at Johns Hopkins examines gender and regional disparities in access to digital literacy, and I currently shape AI policy and faculty AI integration at Abu Dhabi Polytechnic.

Skills

- **Instructional design:** ADDIE, Understanding by Design (UbD), needs analysis, learning objectives, assessment design
- **Digital learning:** online and blended course design, Learning Management System (LMS) integration, interactive content redesign, virtual facilitation
- **Artificial Intelligence (AI) in education:** generative AI integration, AI and digital policy frameworks, digital and media literacy
- **Adult learning and L&D:** faculty and trainer development, onboarding design, the 70-20-10 model, training for behavior change and transfer
- **Evaluation and data:** program evaluation, learning analytics, survey research, data-informed content design
- **Product and venture:** EdTech platform development, grant writing, cross-cultural stakeholder management
- **Tools:** LMS: Canvas, Moodle, Blackboard, Google Classroom · Authoring and design: Articulate, Canva, Gamma · AI: ChatGPT, Claude · Data and surveys: Qualtrics, Google Forms, Microsoft Excel

Professional Experience

Founder & Learning Design Consultant · KZ Development & Consulting · Abu Dhabi, UAE · Jul 2024 – Present

- Lead a consultancy whose team has partnered with international schools in Panama, Egypt, Venezuela, Turkey, and the UK, reaching 1,000+ educators through workshops and professional development.
- Design and facilitate professional development workshops on curriculum and instruction, assessment and feedback, and systems thinking; designed a multi-phase student learning communities program for Grades 3–6, including the workshop series, teacher tools, and implementation plan delivered by the KZ team.
- Build every workshop around application and on-the-job transfer, so teachers leave with strategies they can use in their own classrooms.
- Write client proposals and multi-phase implementation plans tailored to each school's priorities.
- Publish L&D thought leadership to 1,700+ LinkedIn followers, including a 30-day series on learning culture and evidence-based training.

Instructor · Abu Dhabi Polytechnic · Abu Dhabi, UAE · Jan 2026 – Present

- Teach public speaking, literature review, and report writing to 150+ students each semester.
- Partner with faculty to integrate Artificial Intelligence (AI) appropriately into their course design and teaching.
- Work with the Student Learning Center to build student AI literacy and support responsible AI use across the university.
- Serve on the AI, Policy, and Quality Assurance committees, shaping institutional AI policy and academic quality standards.

Co-Founder & Chief Learning Officer · O'Bilim · Tashkent, Uzbekistan · Mar 2023 – Dec 2025

- Turned the founding idea into the company's vision, strategy, and full business plan for an online learning platform designed to close the gender digital divide in Uzbekistan.
- Researched and designed the complete curriculum, from learning outcomes to lesson sequence and assessment.
- Wrote all video lesson scripts, sourced and managed the video production company, and presented on camera.
- Designed data-informed evaluation tools and secured international grant funding through a competitive proposal.

Advisory Board Member · International Greenwich Olympiad (North London Grammar School) · Remote · Mar 2024 – Present

- Advise on the academic design of international STEM and sustainability competitions and align them with global education standards.

Leadership & Public Speaking Instructor · NYU Abu Dhabi Summer Academy · Abu Dhabi, UAE · Jun 2025 – Sep 2025

- Designed and taught leadership and public speaking sessions for high-achieving Emirati students.

Assistant Professor, M.A. in Education and Innovation & Undergraduate Programs · Webster University Tashkent · Tashkent, Uzbekistan · Dec 2019 – Aug 2024

- Designed and taught graduate courses on ethical use of digital tools, collaborative virtual environments, and research writing.
- Integrated instructional technology and media literacy across in-person and online courses.
- Mentored graduate capstone writers, including internationally recognized award winners.

Head of Faculty Training & Development and Student Success · Webster University Tashkent · Tashkent, Uzbekistan · Dec 2019 – Aug 2022

- Founded the faculty development and student success departments, supporting 175+ faculty across eight undergraduate and graduate departments and 40+ staff with professional development tailored through needs assessments and feedback data.
- Designed training and student support systems for the transition to online learning.
- Implemented university-wide academic integrity and retention initiatives.

IB Teacher & AI Policy Committee Member · Tashkent International School · Tashkent, Uzbekistan · Aug 2022 – Jun 2024

- Served on the Innovative Technology and AI Policy Advisory Committee, helping write the school's AI and digital policy framework for K–12. Helped run needs-assessment sessions on teachers' AI experience, understanding, and concerns, then used the findings to co-design a workshop on how each department could use AI and teach students to use it in their learning.
- Taught IB Language & Literature with inquiry-based, technology-integrated methods; used data analytics to lift exam results 9% above the global average.

Online Curriculum Developer & Trainer · Shanghai Yuexin Edutech · Remote · 2018 – 2020

- Designed scalable online curricula for K–12 and adult learners worldwide, including a six-level scope and sequence (kindergarten to Grade 4) of 18 inquiry-based units aligned to IB PYP themes, with unit planners for each.
- Delivered virtual training on effective LMS integration.
- Redesigned content with interactive elements to improve learner engagement.

Earlier Experience

- **IB Authorization Consultant** · Smart School · Tashkent, Uzbekistan · Jul 2022 – Dec 2022. Guided the school to full IB Diploma Programme authorization.
- **PYP Coordinator** · Westhill Institute · Mexico · Aug 2018 – Jun 2019. Led the school's IB PYP self-study, organizing teachers into committees aligned to IB standards; the school passed its evaluation. Led a whole-school Programme of Inquiry review (preschool to Grade 5), aligning units with Mexico's national standards, Common Core, and NGSS.
- **Dean of Students (Middle School), After-School Activities Coordinator & Teacher** · Albanian College · Tirana, Albania · Aug 2015 – Jun 2018
- **Middle School Teacher** · Multiple schools · Nashville, Tennessee · 2011 – 2015
- **Head of Preschool** · Sunnyside Academy · New York, NY · 2008 – 2010

Education

Doctor of Education (Ed.D.), Entrepreneurial Leadership in Education · Johns Hopkins University · Dissertation complete; conferral expected Dec 2026

- Dissertation: *Access to Digital Literacy in Uzbekistan: Gender and Regional Disparities*

Master of Education, Teaching and Learning in Urban Settings · Peabody College, Vanderbilt University · 2015

Bachelor of Science, Interdisciplinary Studies (Education) · University of Houston · 2009

Graduate coursework, Curriculum & Instruction, and Middle Grades Teaching Endorsement · Tennessee State University · 2011

Certifications & Professional Training

- Certificate in Management & Leadership · Harvard Business School Online · 2022
- Understanding by Design (UbD) · Metro Nashville Public Schools · 2012
- IB certifications: DP English A (2022), Theory of Knowledge (2021), MYP Leadership (2019), Making the PYP Happen (2016, 2019)
- AVID Summer Institute · 2014
- Tennessee Teaching Certificate · Tennessee Department of Education · 2011

Languages

English (native) · Albanian (basic) · Russian and Spanish (beginner)